Unit 6

Accompanying

New: Three staves: a singer's line above the piano; introductions and interludes; following the soloist

Most pianists who read at sight do it for someone else: a singer, a violinist, a choir. The score then has three staves: the soloist's line on top (smaller, or with words under it) and the two piano staves below. The pianist plays the piano part and reads the soloist's line at the same time, to know where the music is going, to breathe with the soloist, and to wait at a pause.
In this unit the singer's line is sung to "la" in the exercises, and to the poet's words in the songs. Read the top line as part of the music, not as decoration: it is the tune your accompaniment supports.

What is new

The soloist's staff

The top staff, joined to the piano by a bar line or a separate bracket, is the soloist's. The piano's two staves are joined by the brace. Your hands play only the braced staves; your eyes read all three.

Introductions and interludes

When the soloist rests, the piano leads: the introduction sets the speed and the mood, an interlude joins two phrases. Play them in time, and give the soloist a clear beat to come in on.

After-beats

A bass note on the beat and chords on the off-beats (oom-pah, oom-pah-pah) keep a song moving. Keep the chords light and the bass clear.

Doubling the tune

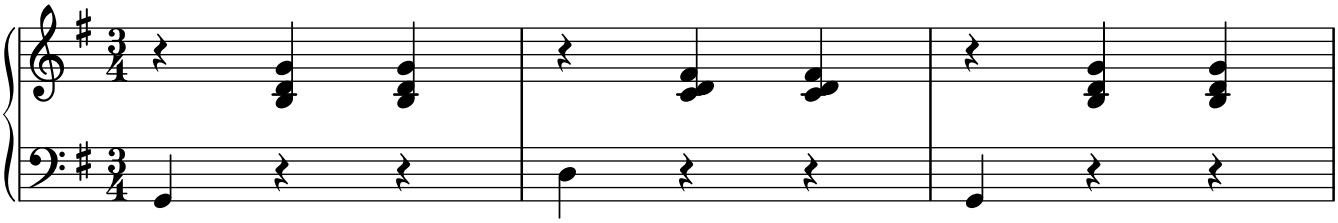
In some bars the piano's top note plays the singer's tune; in others it does not. Where it doubles, play it gently: the singer has it already.

Following the soloist

At a pause (fermata) in the voice, the pianist waits and watches; a rest in the voice is counted exactly. Breathe with the singer at the ends of phrases.

An introduction, then an after-beat accompaniment

Two bars of piano set the speed; the voice (top line in the songs) comes in on bar 3. Bass on the beat, chords after it.



Reading tips

1. Before you play, read the soloist's line: where does it rest, where does it pause, where is its high note?

2. Count the soloist's rests aloud in your head; come in with the soloist, not after.

3. Keep the accompaniment softer than the tune: the singer must be heard.
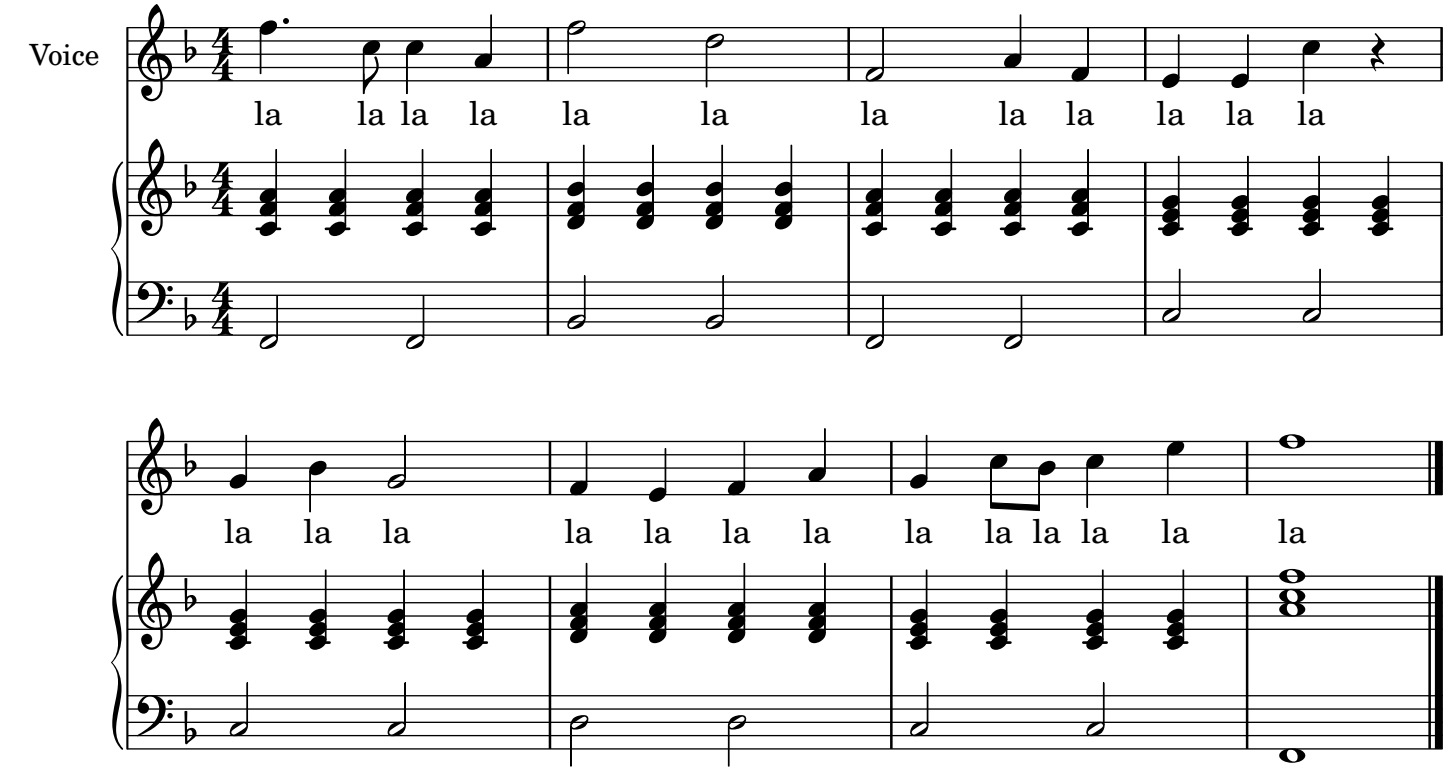
4. At a fermata in the voice, hold your chord and watch for the next breath.

5. If you must simplify, keep the bass and the rhythm of the accompaniment; drop inner notes.
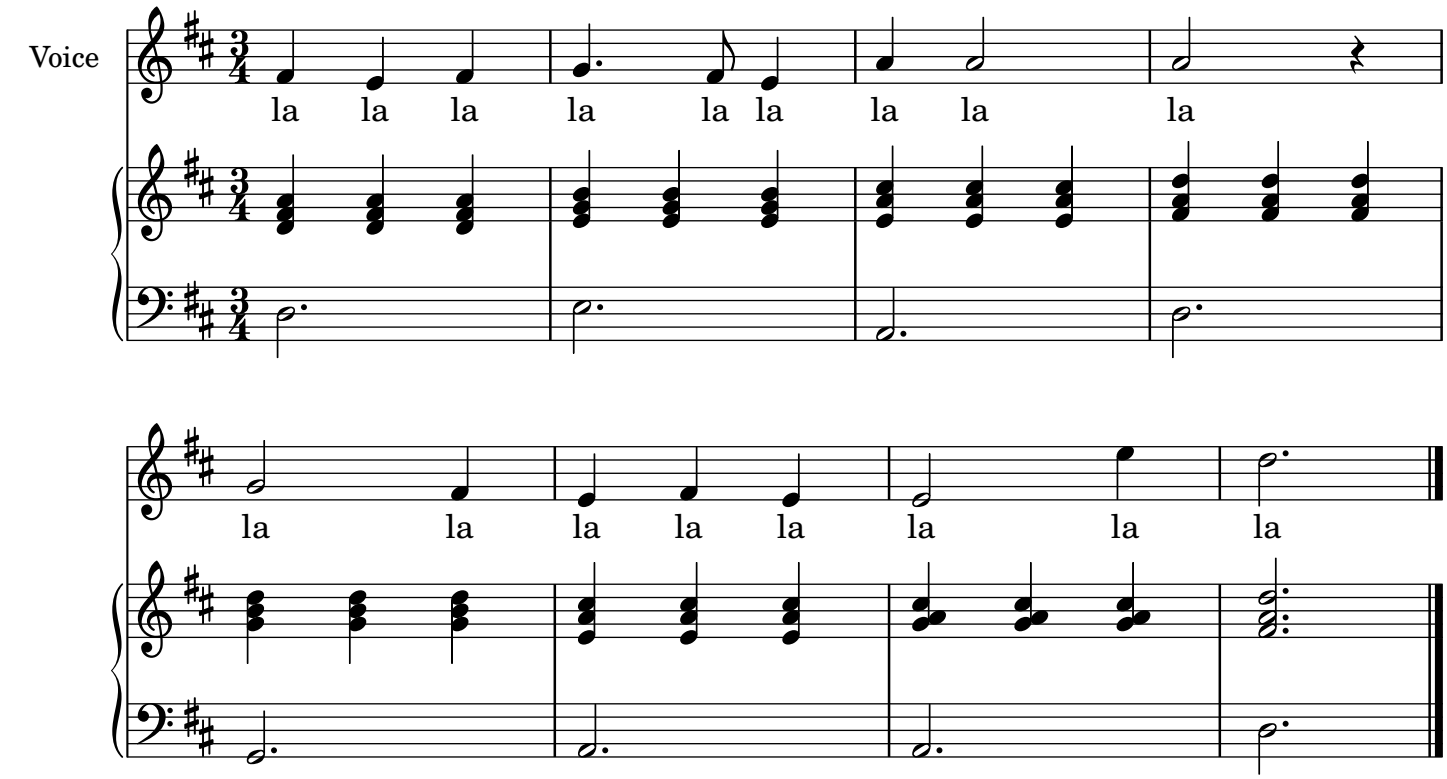
Part A: A singer's line over block chords ♩ = 72

A singer's line (sung to "la") above block chords on every beat, the bass in long notes. 4/4 and 3/4. The singer breathes (a quarter rest) in bar 4.
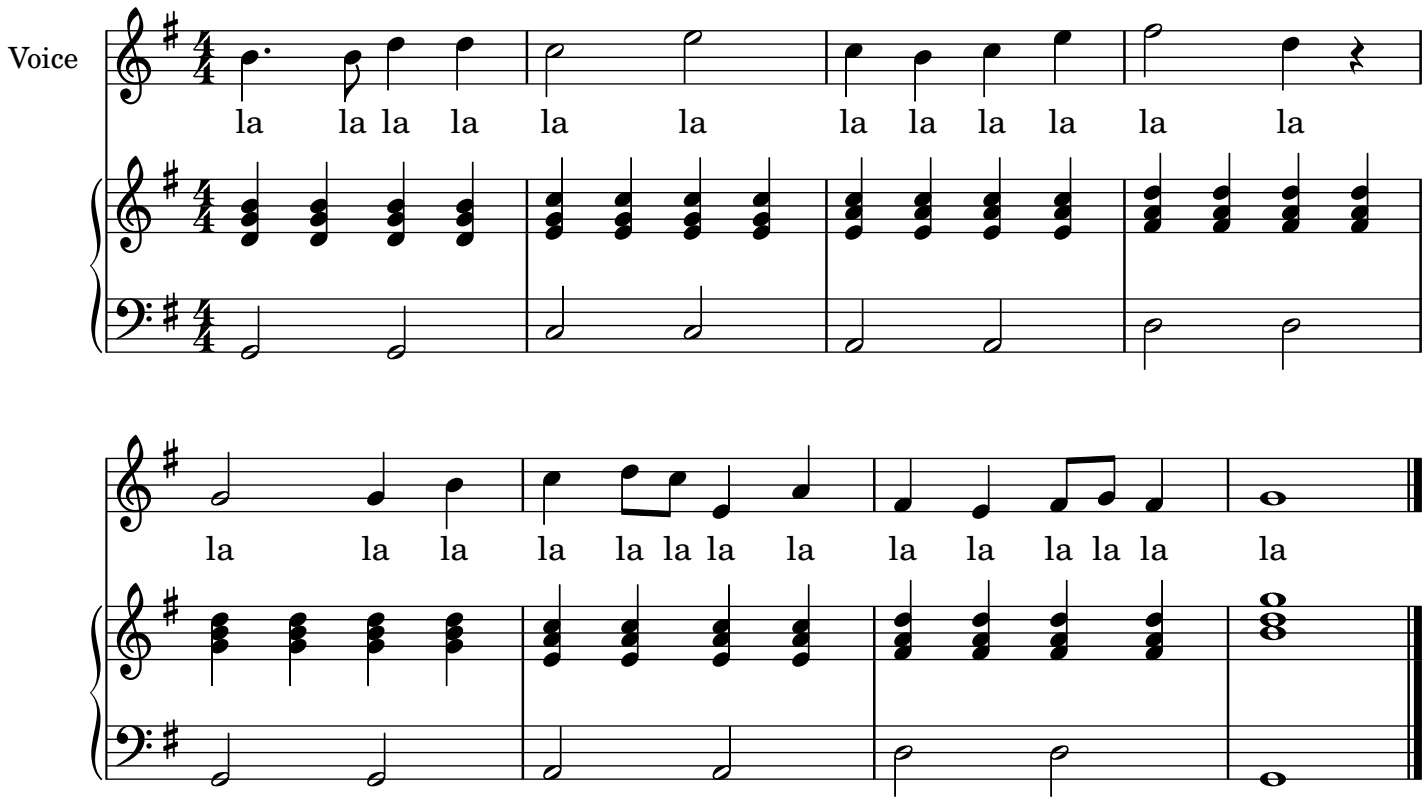
6.1
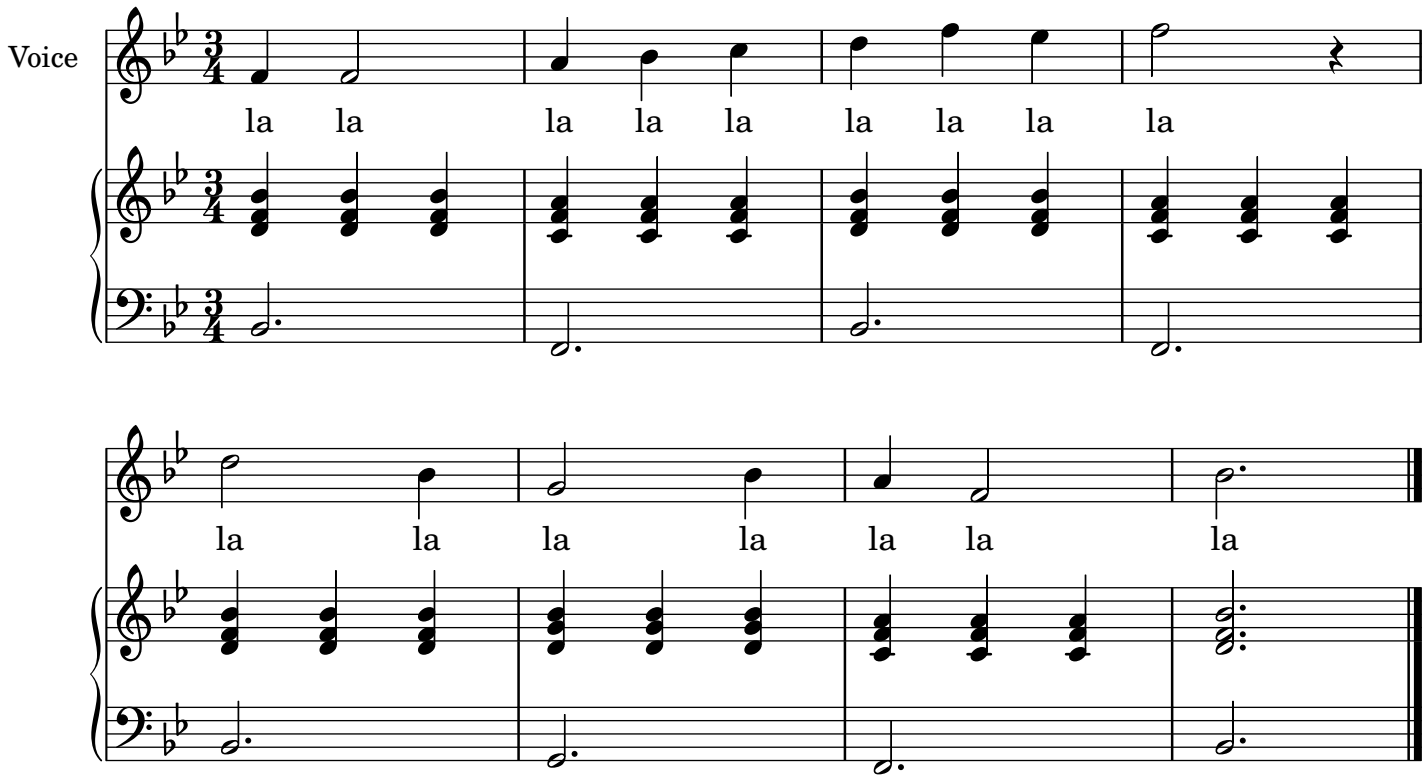


6.2 ♩ = 88
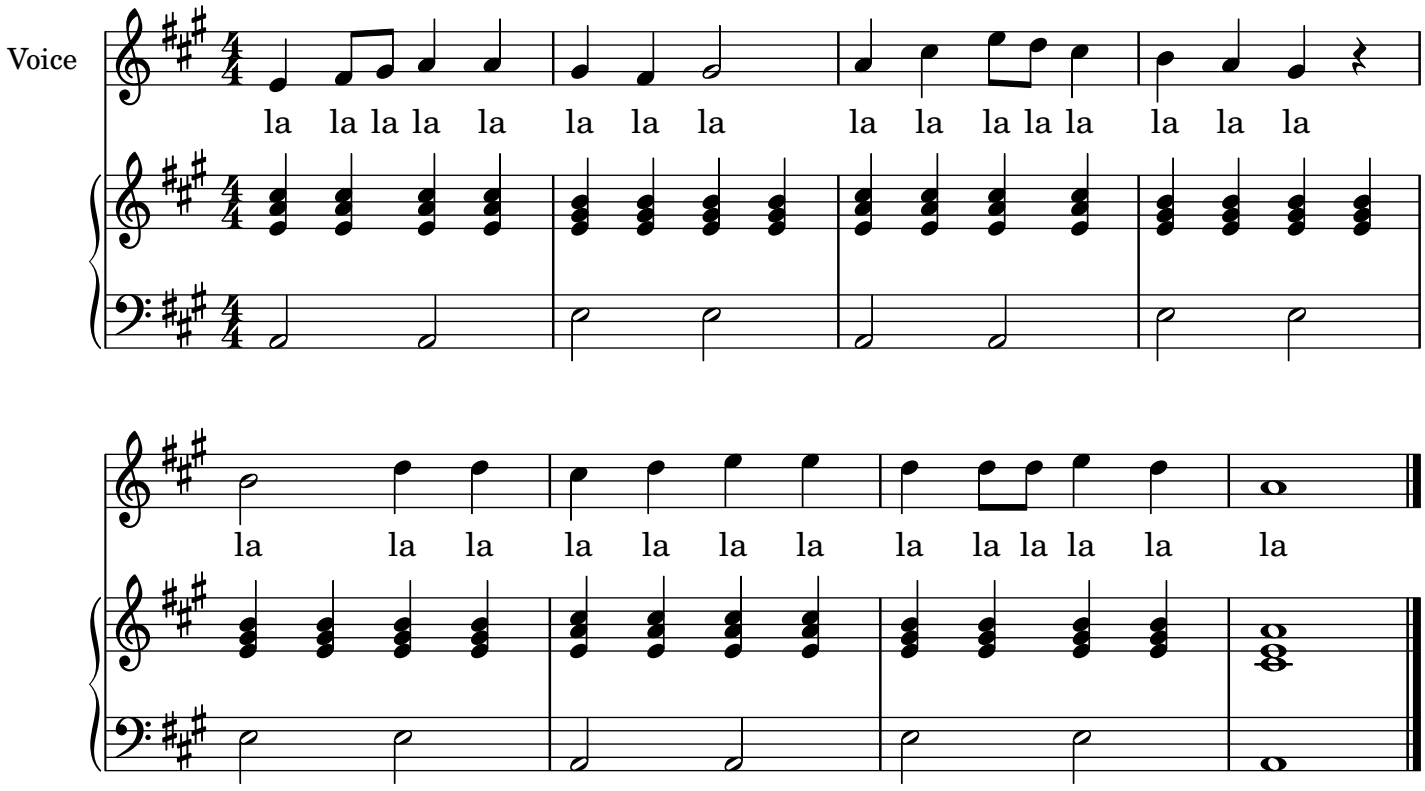


6.3


Voice
la la la la la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la la la la la
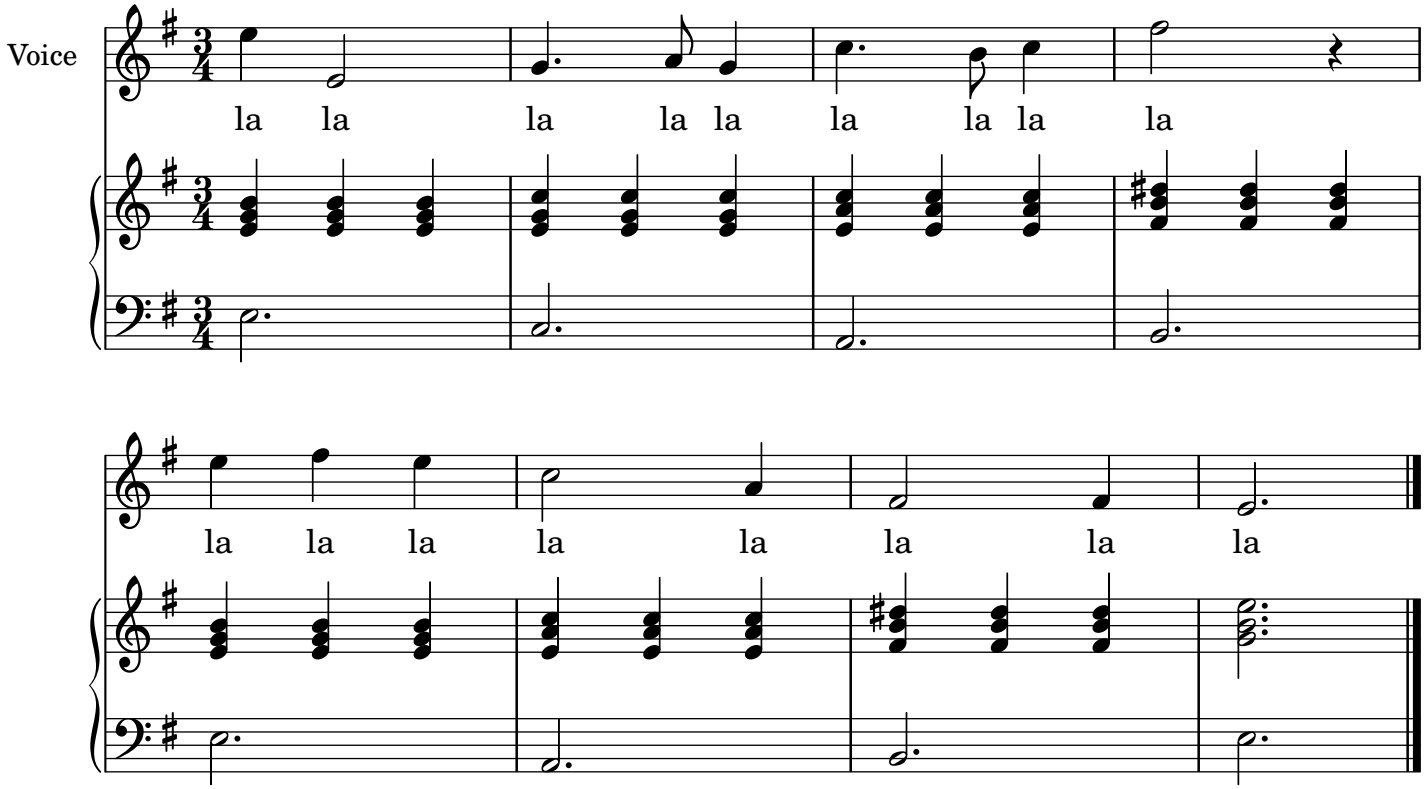
6.4 ♩ = 88


Voice
la la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la
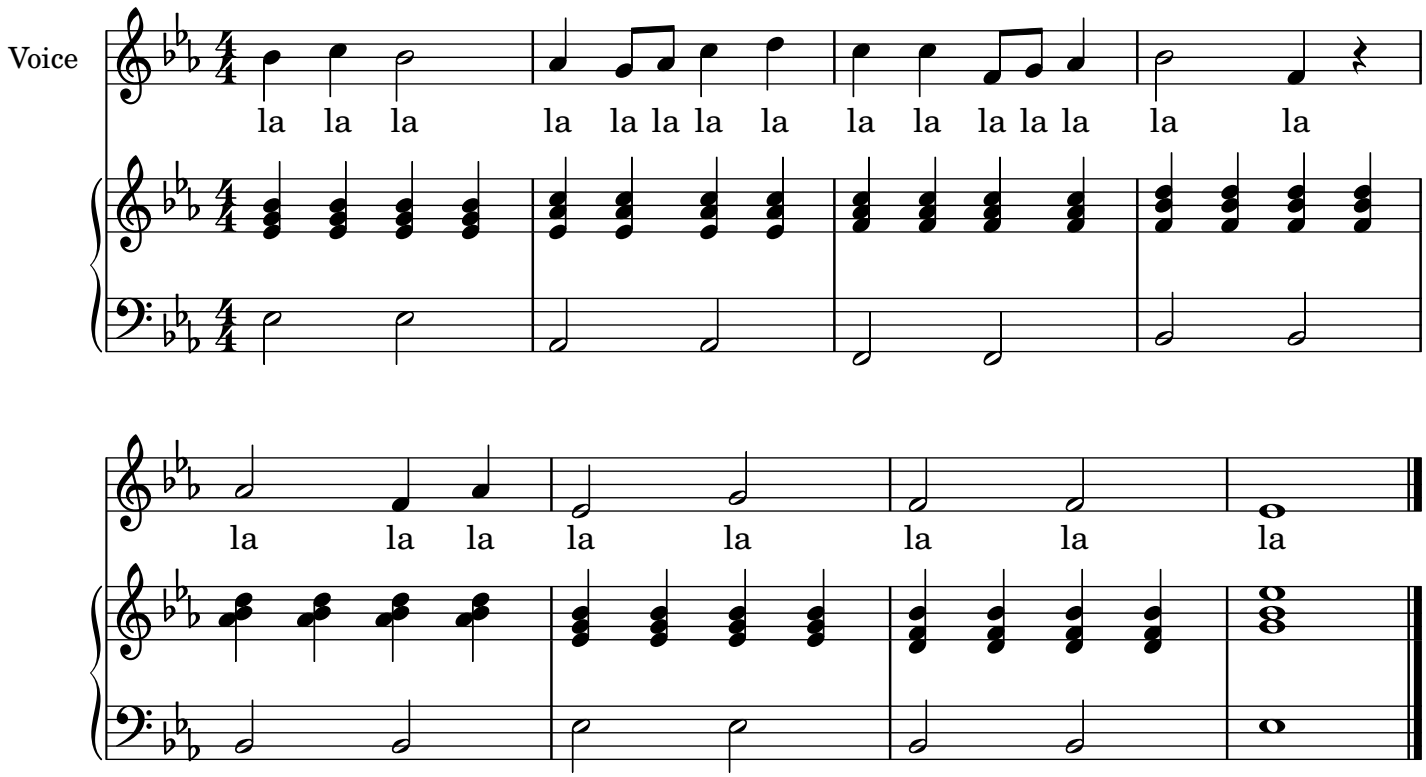
6.5


Voice
la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la la la la la
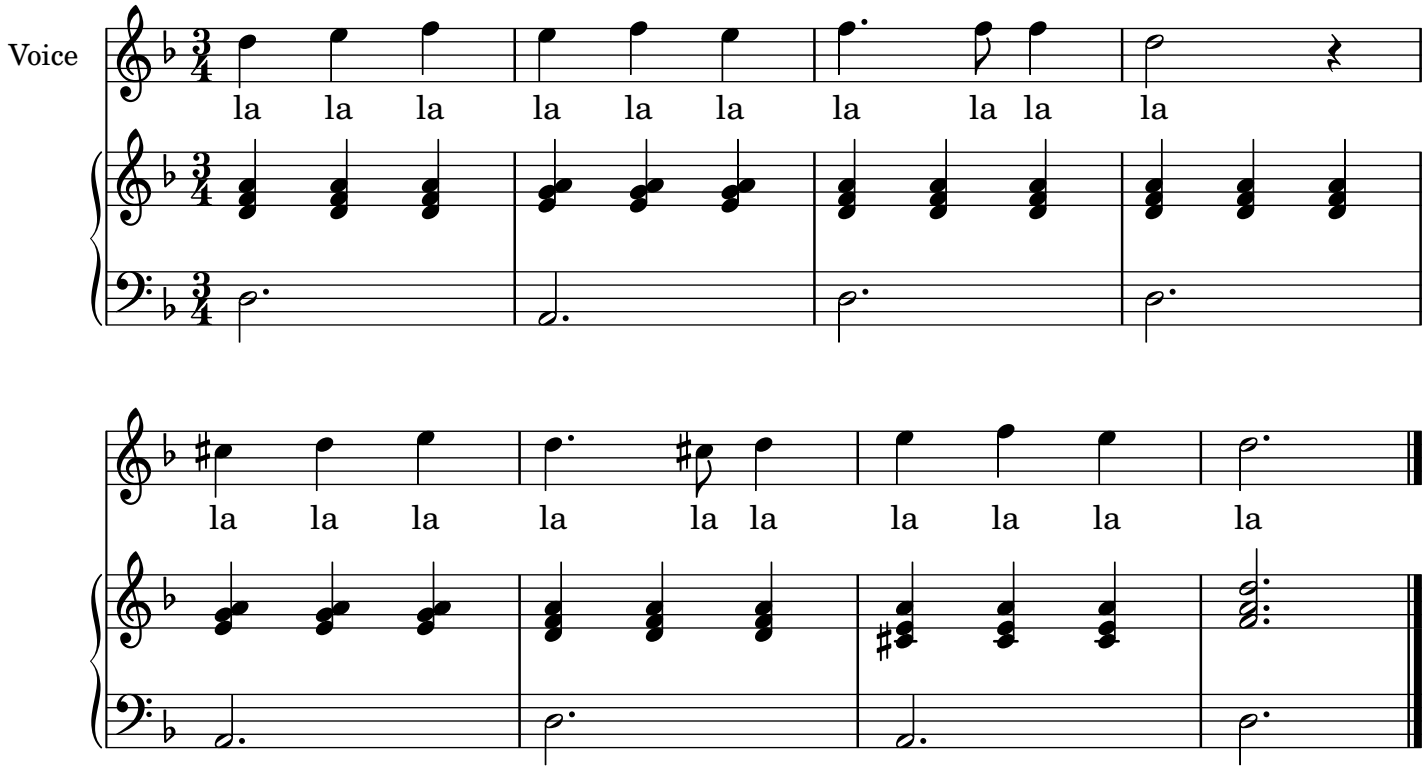
6.6 ♩ = 88


Voice
la la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la

6.7


Voice
la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la
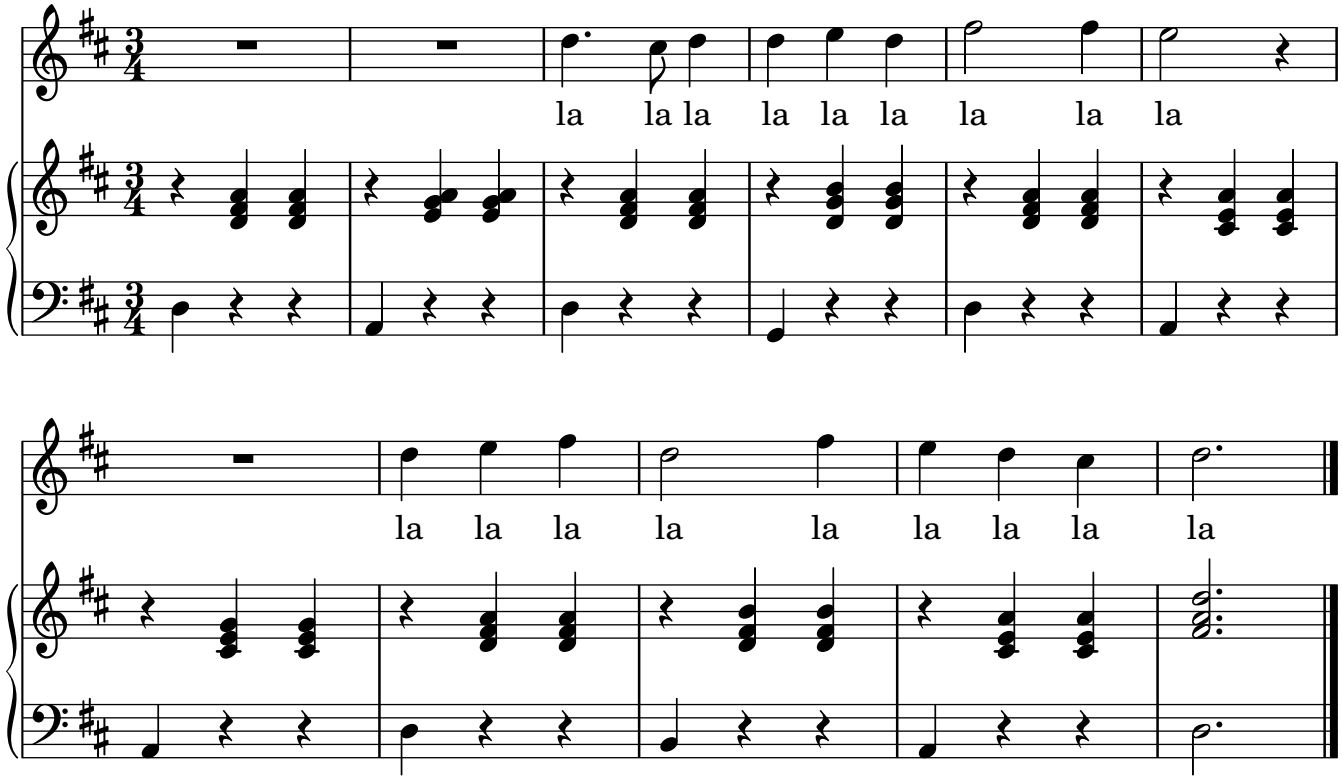
6.8 ♩ = 88


Voice
la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la
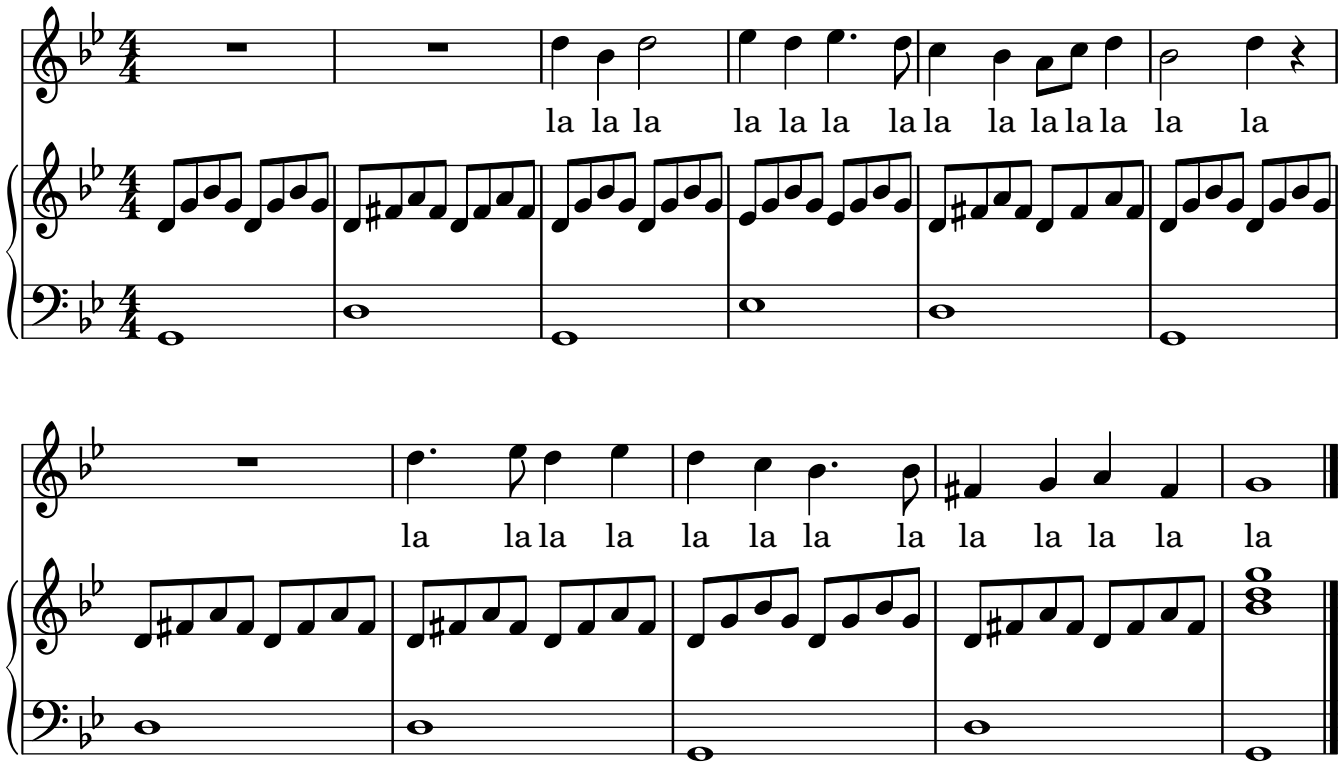
Part B: Introductions, interludes, after-beats and arpeggios

Two bars of piano introduction, the first phrase, a bar of piano interlude, the second phrase.
3/4 exercises use an after-beat accompaniment, 4/4 exercises broken chords in eighths.

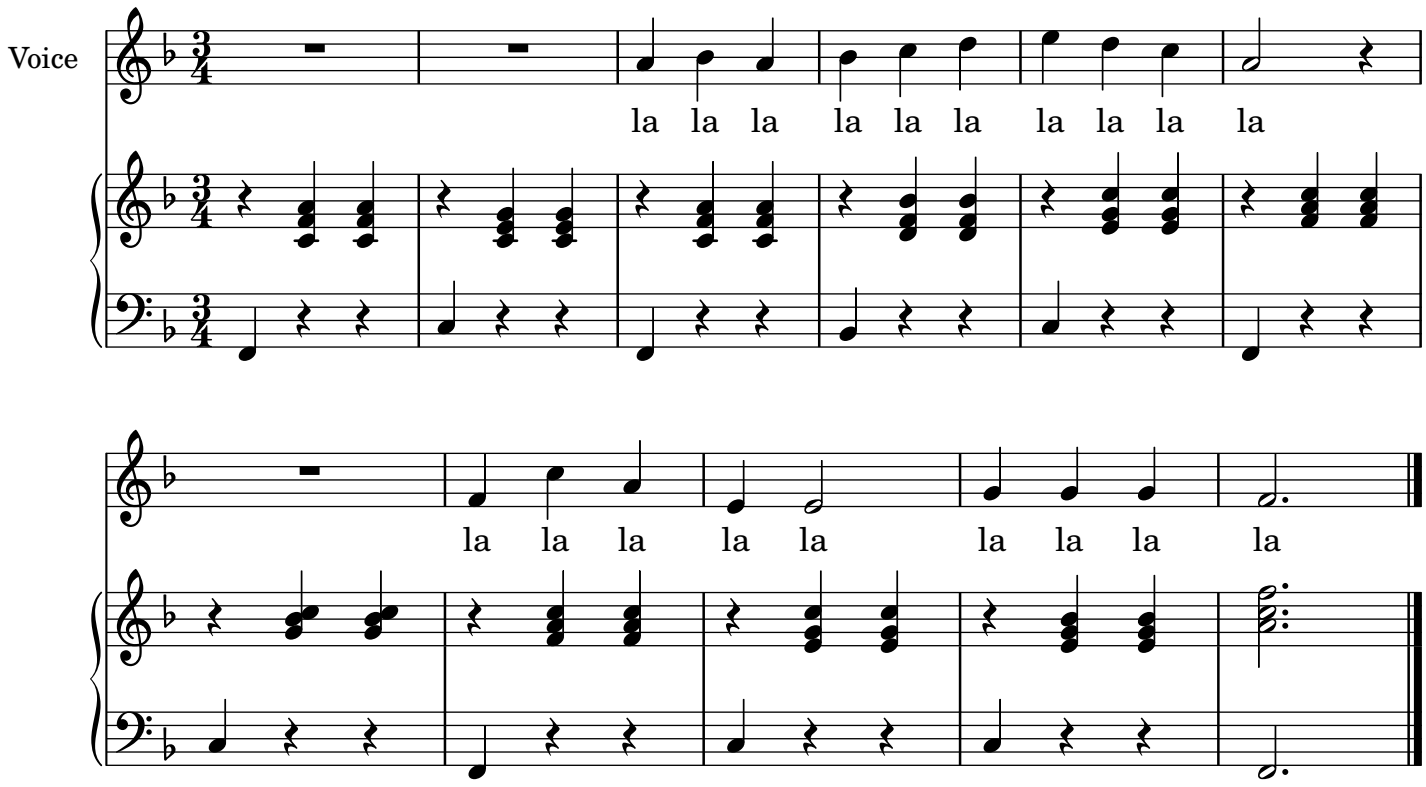
6.9
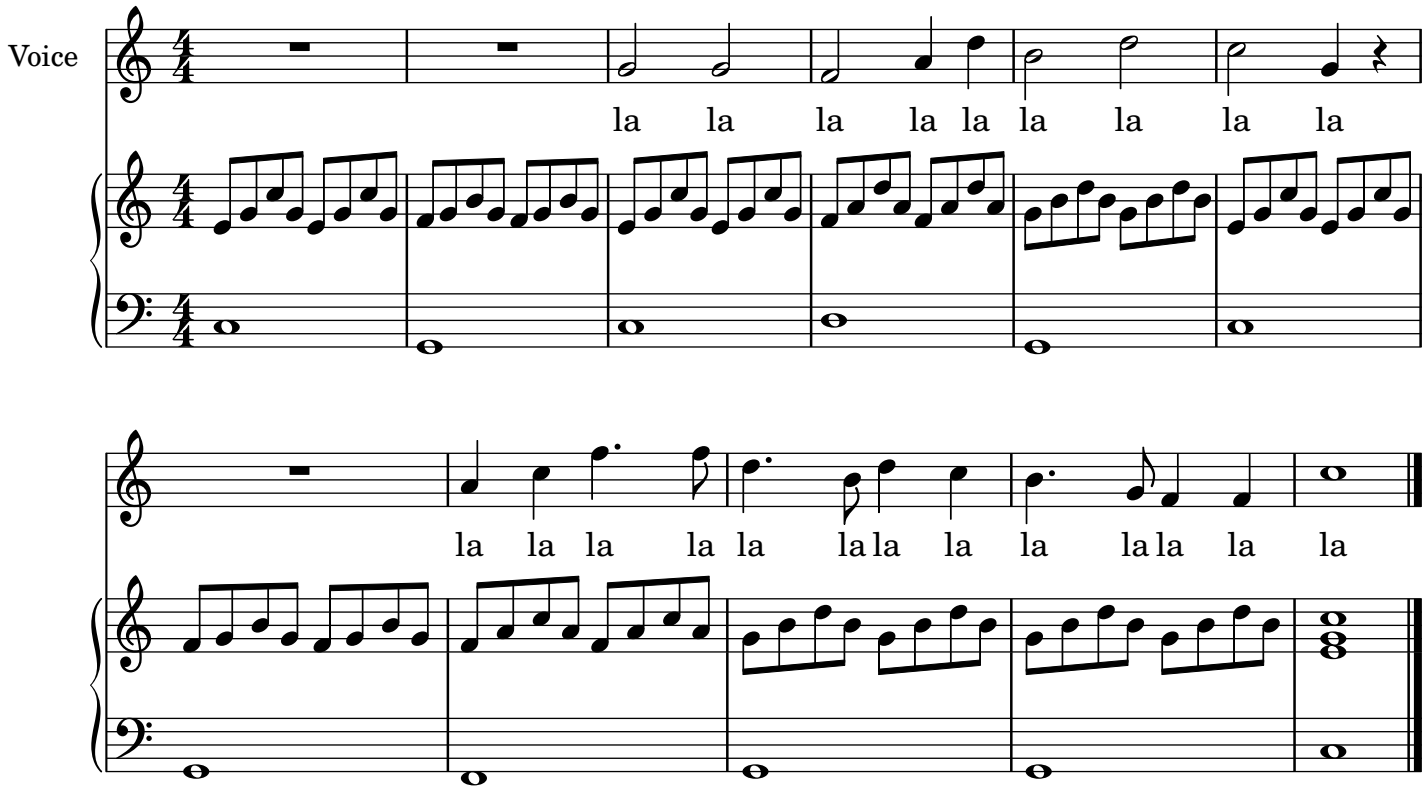


6.10 ♩ = 66
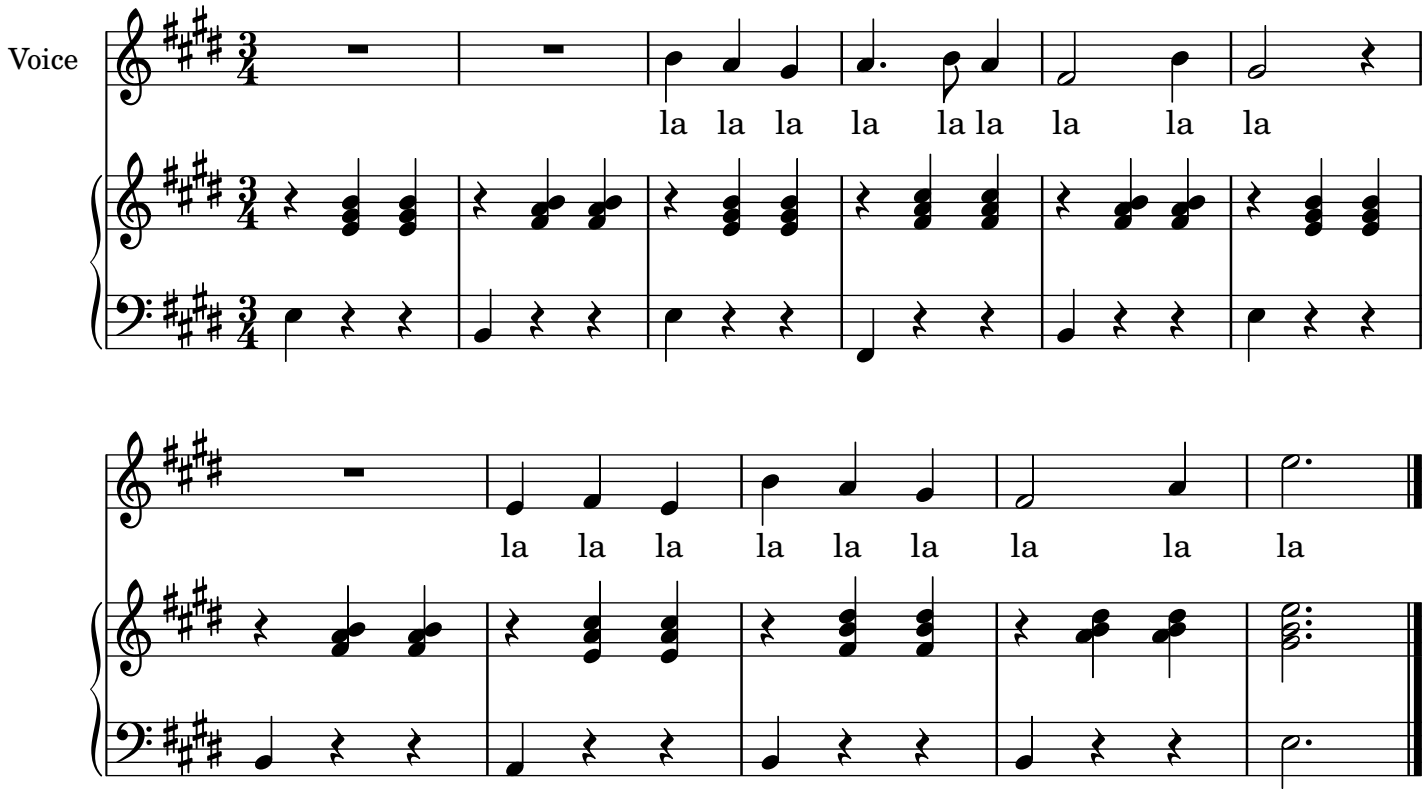


6.11


Voice
la la la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la
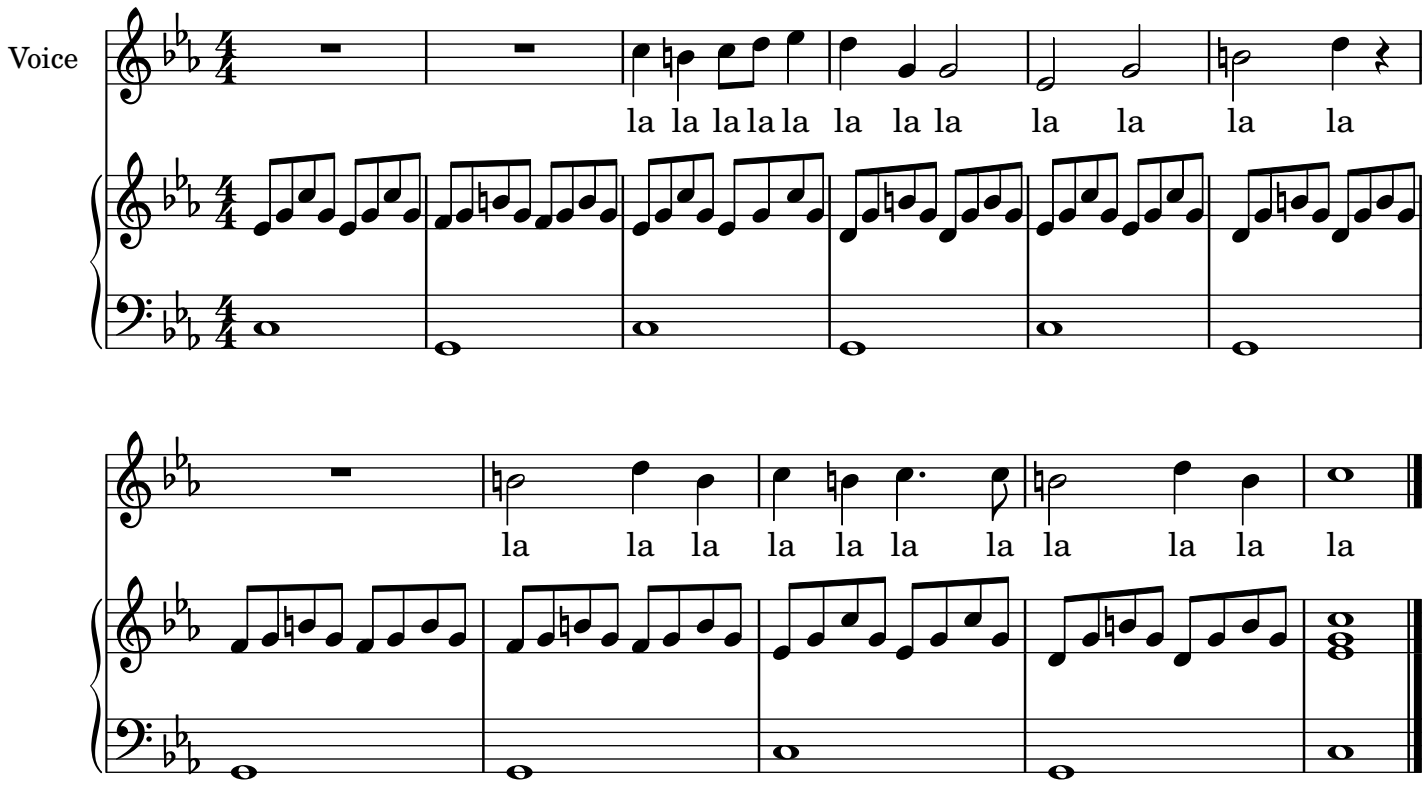
6.12 ♩ = 66


Voice
la la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la la la la la
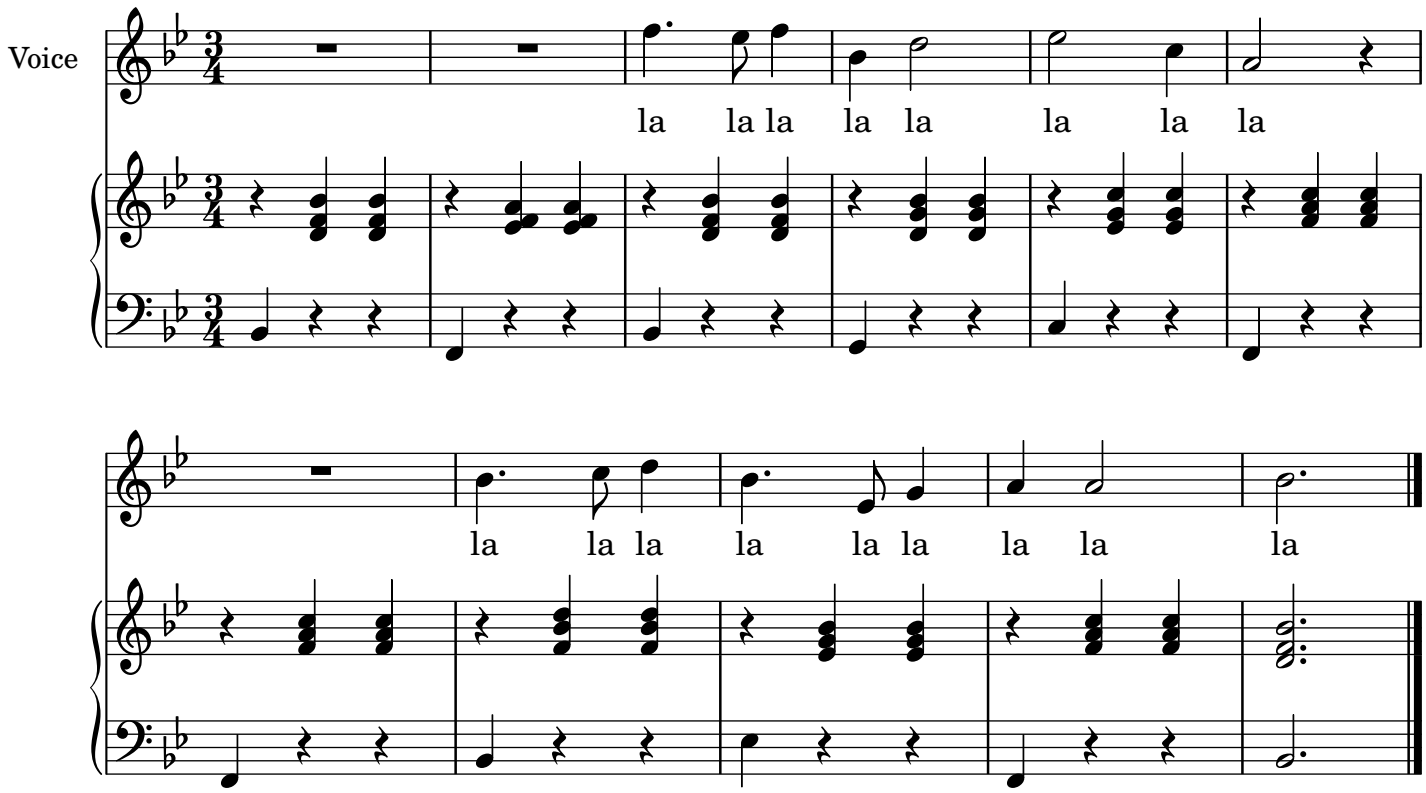
6.13


Voice
la la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la la
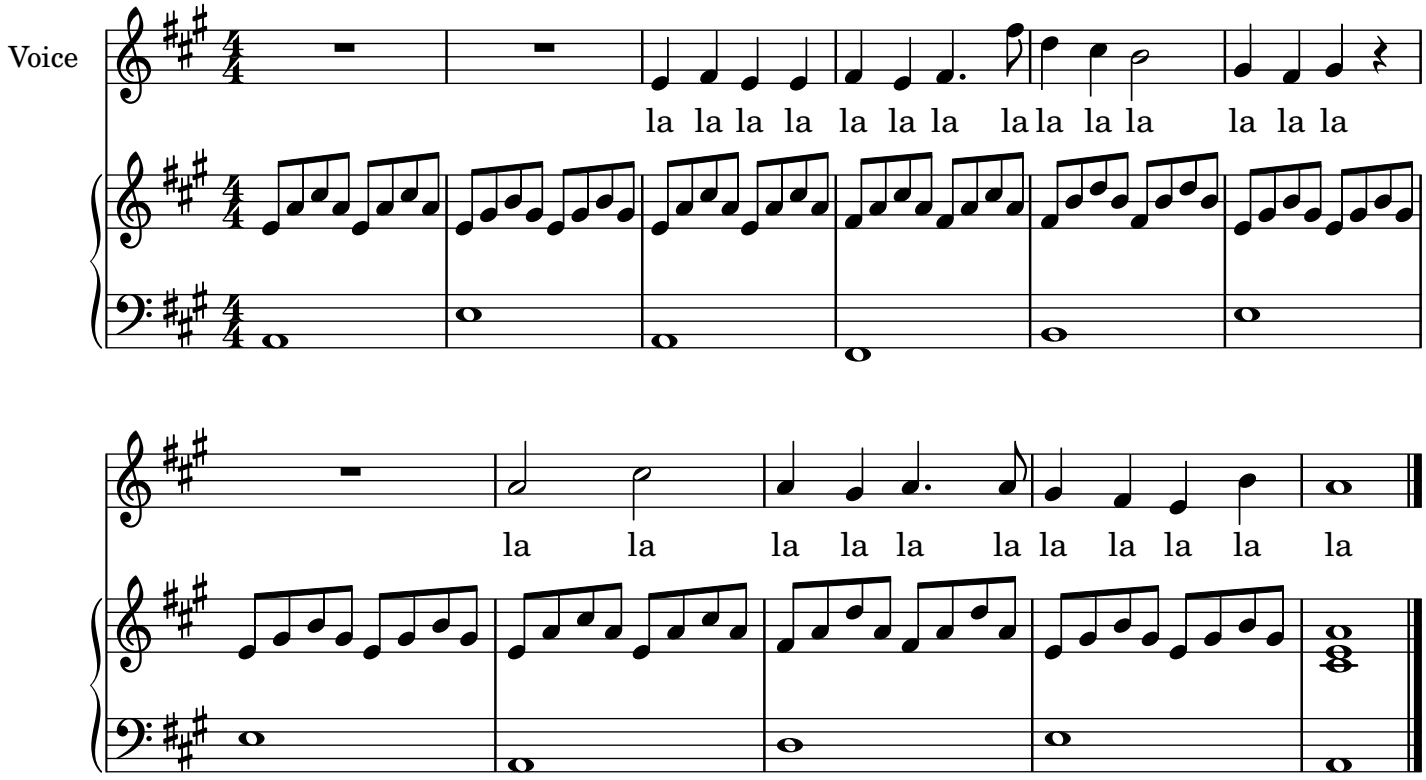
6.14 ♩ = 66


Voice
la la la la la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la la la la

6.15


Voice
la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la
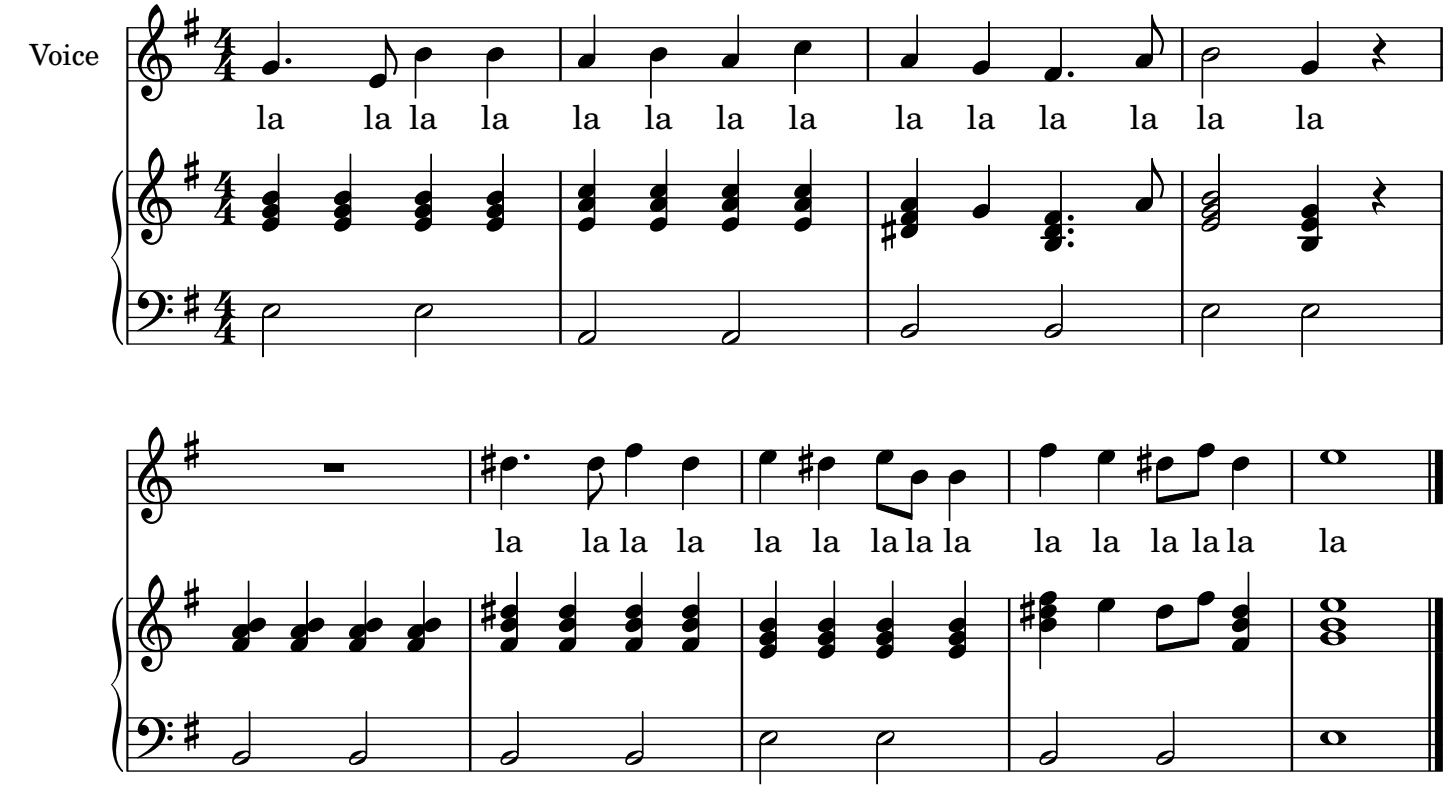
6.16 ♩ = 66


Voice
la la la la la la la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la la la

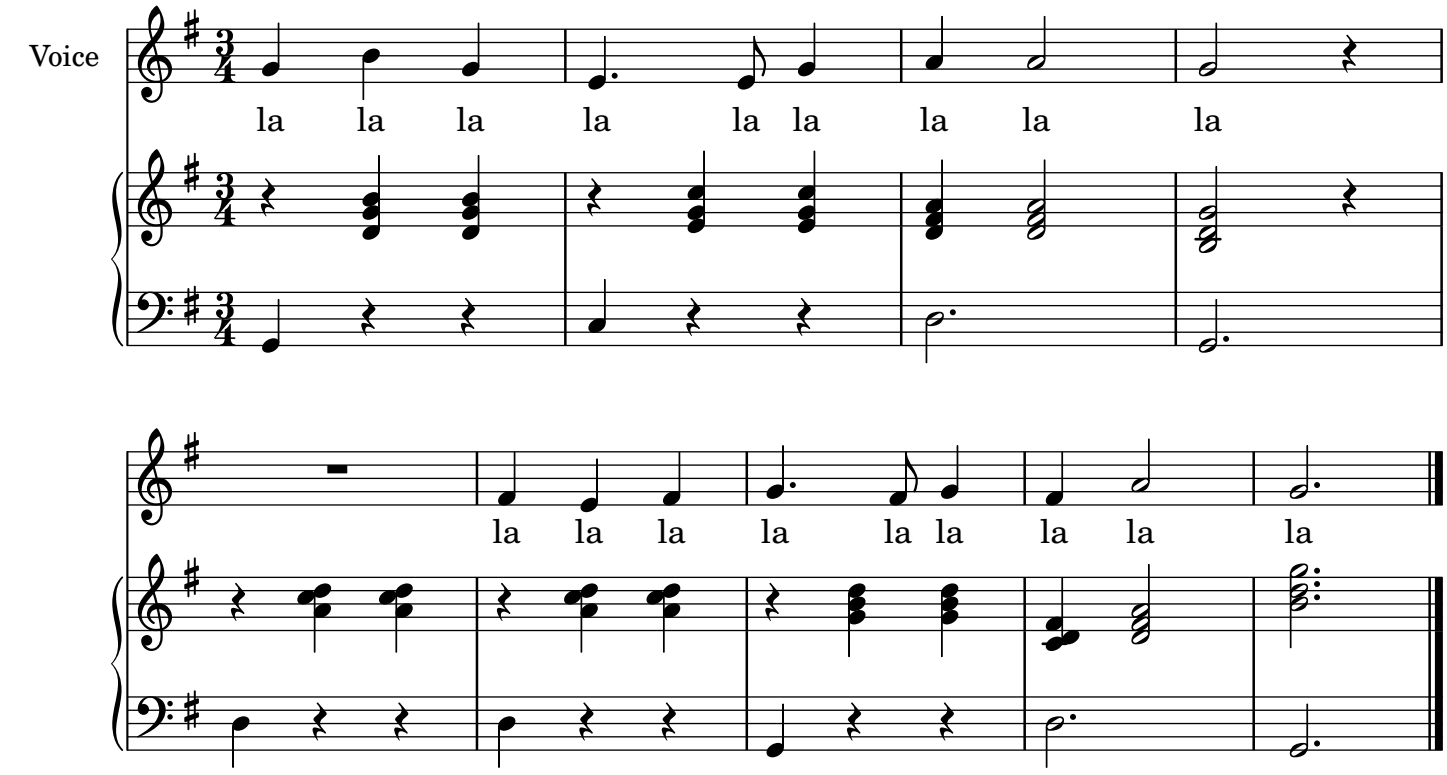
Part C: Doubling the tune; counting the rests ♩ = 72

In bars 3-4 and 7-8 of the singer's line the piano's right hand doubles the tune; in the other bars it plays chords. A bar of interlude in the middle: count the singer's rests.
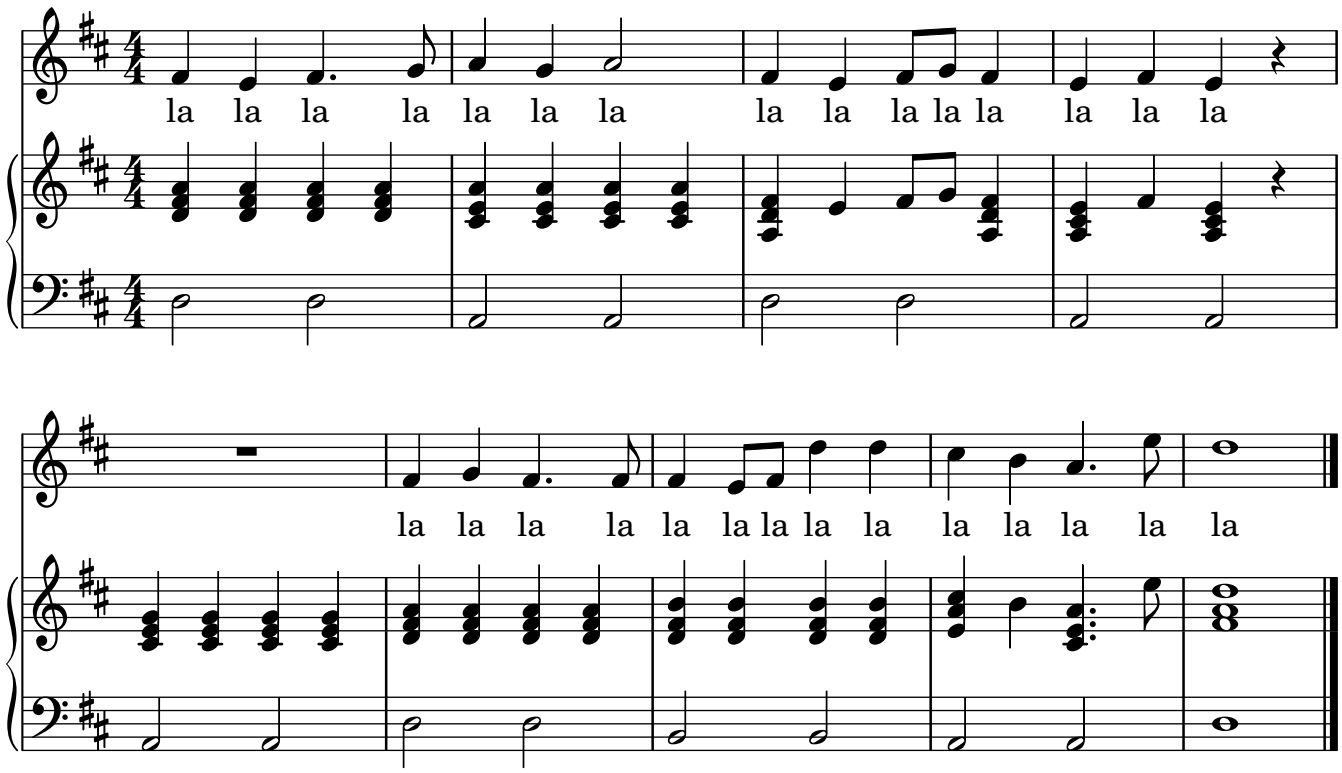
6.17



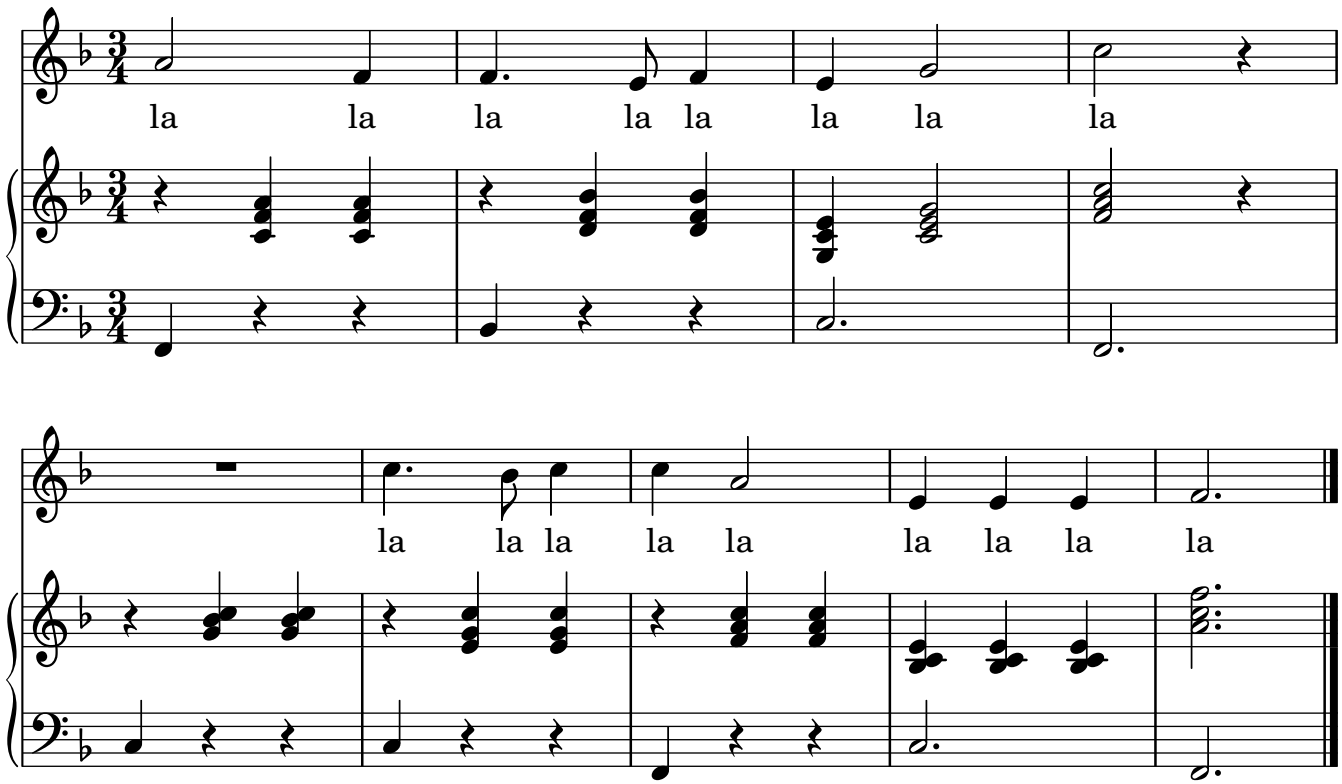
6.18 ♩ = 88
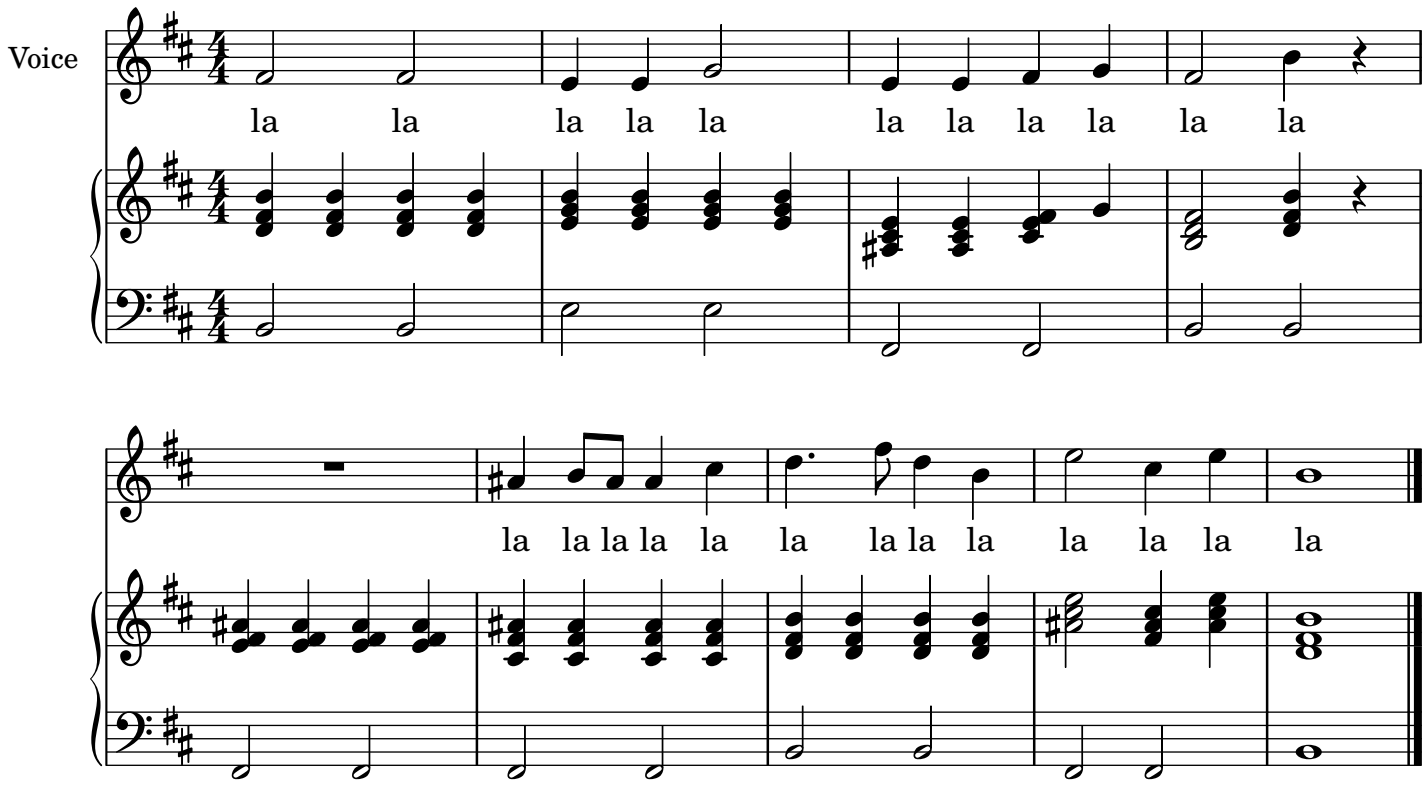


6.19


Voice
la la la la la la la la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la la la la la la

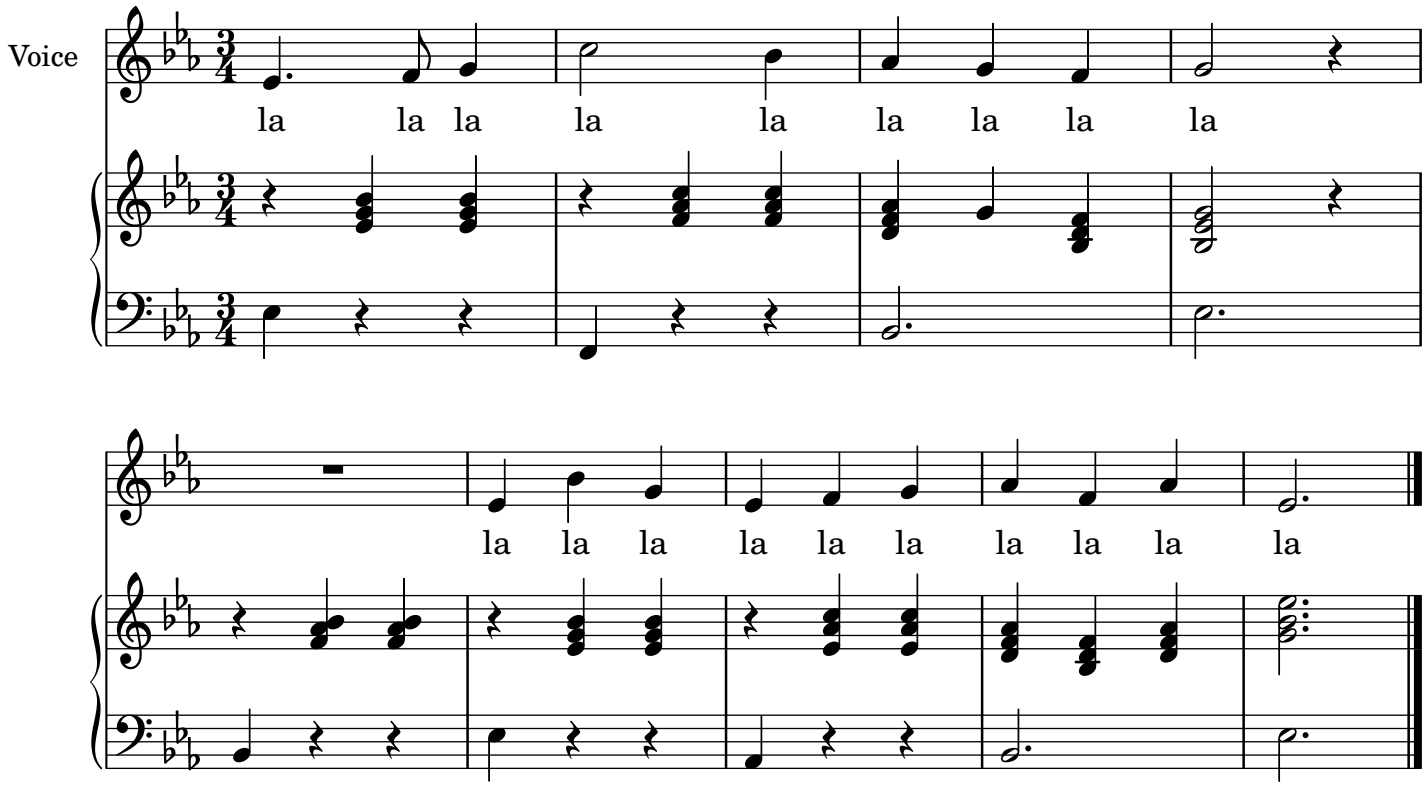
6.20 ♩ = 88


Voice
la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la
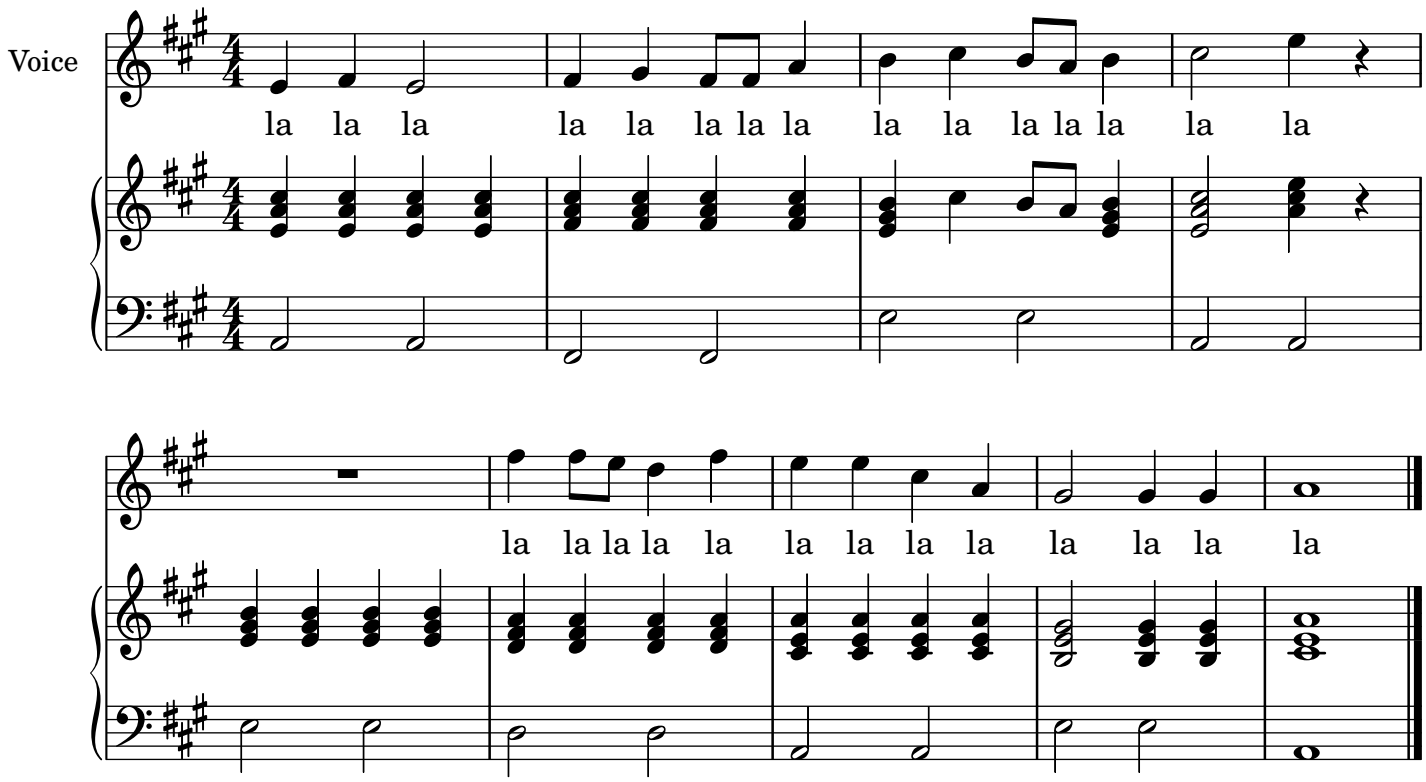
6.21


Voice
la la la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la la la la la
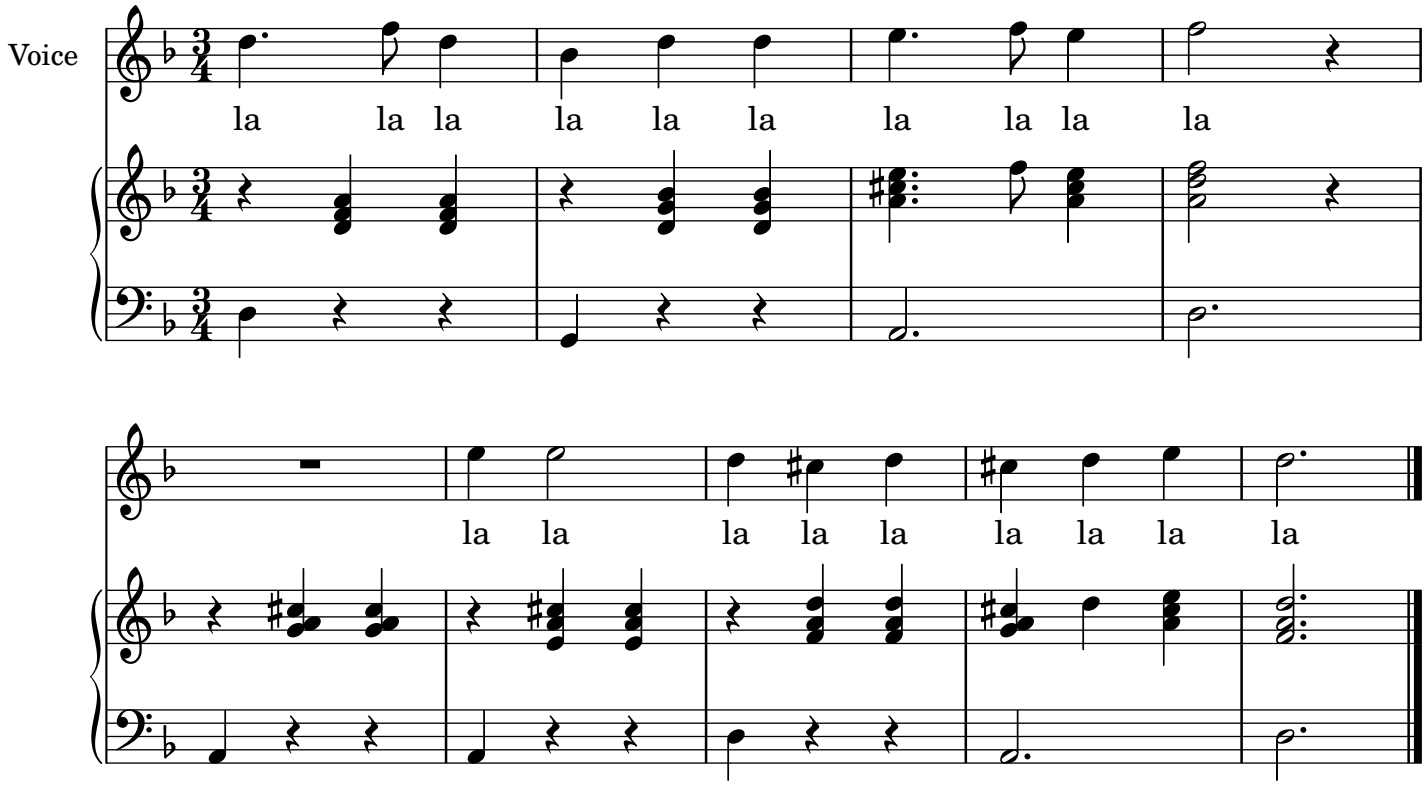
6.22 ♩ = 88


Voice
la la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la la la

6.23


Voice
la la la la la la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la la la la la

6.24 ♩ = 88


Voice
la la la la la la la la la la
la la la la la la la la la la
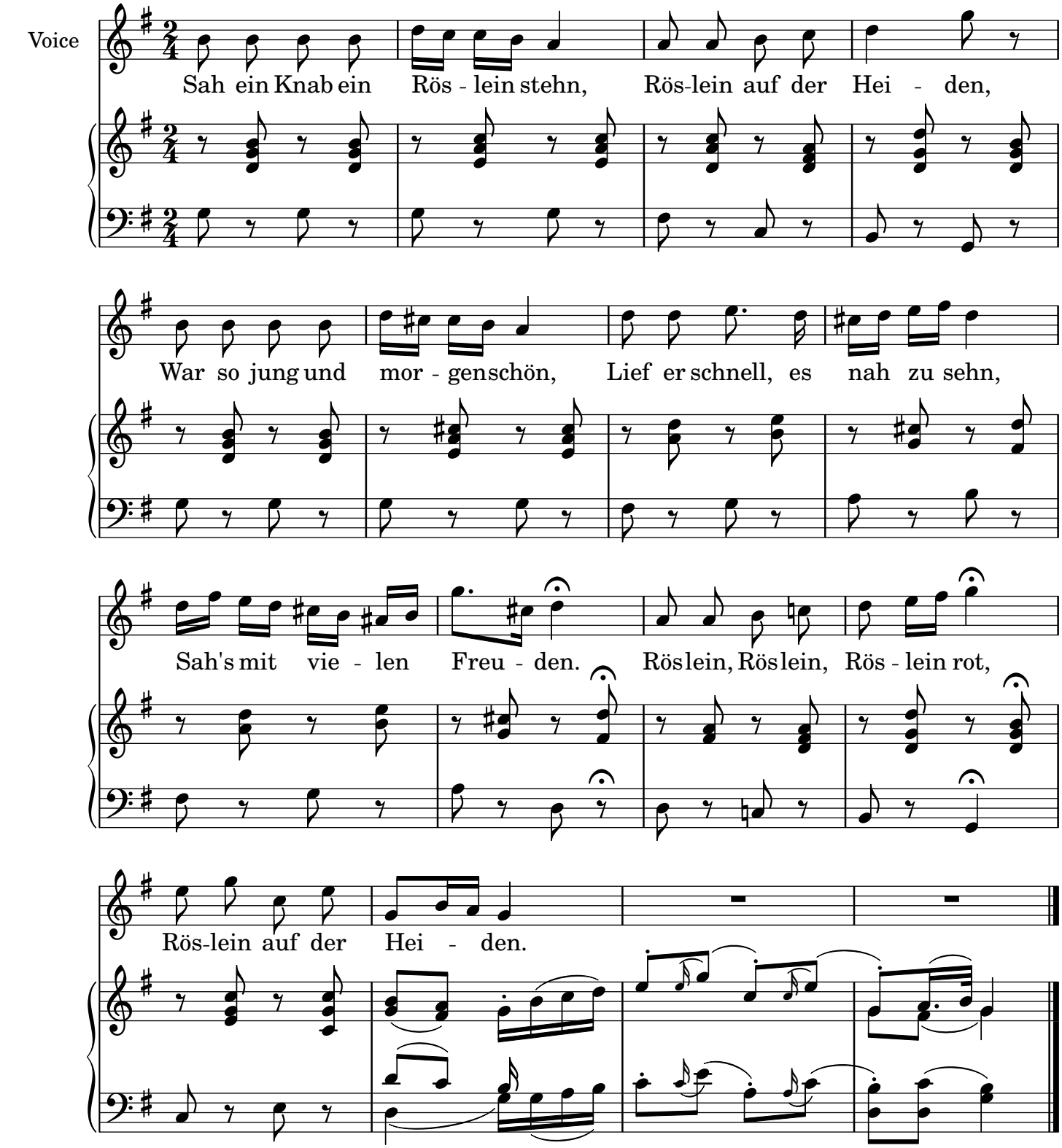
Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Heidenroslein ♩ = 69

Franz Schubert (1815), Heidenroslein D. 257 (words by Goethe) - the first verse
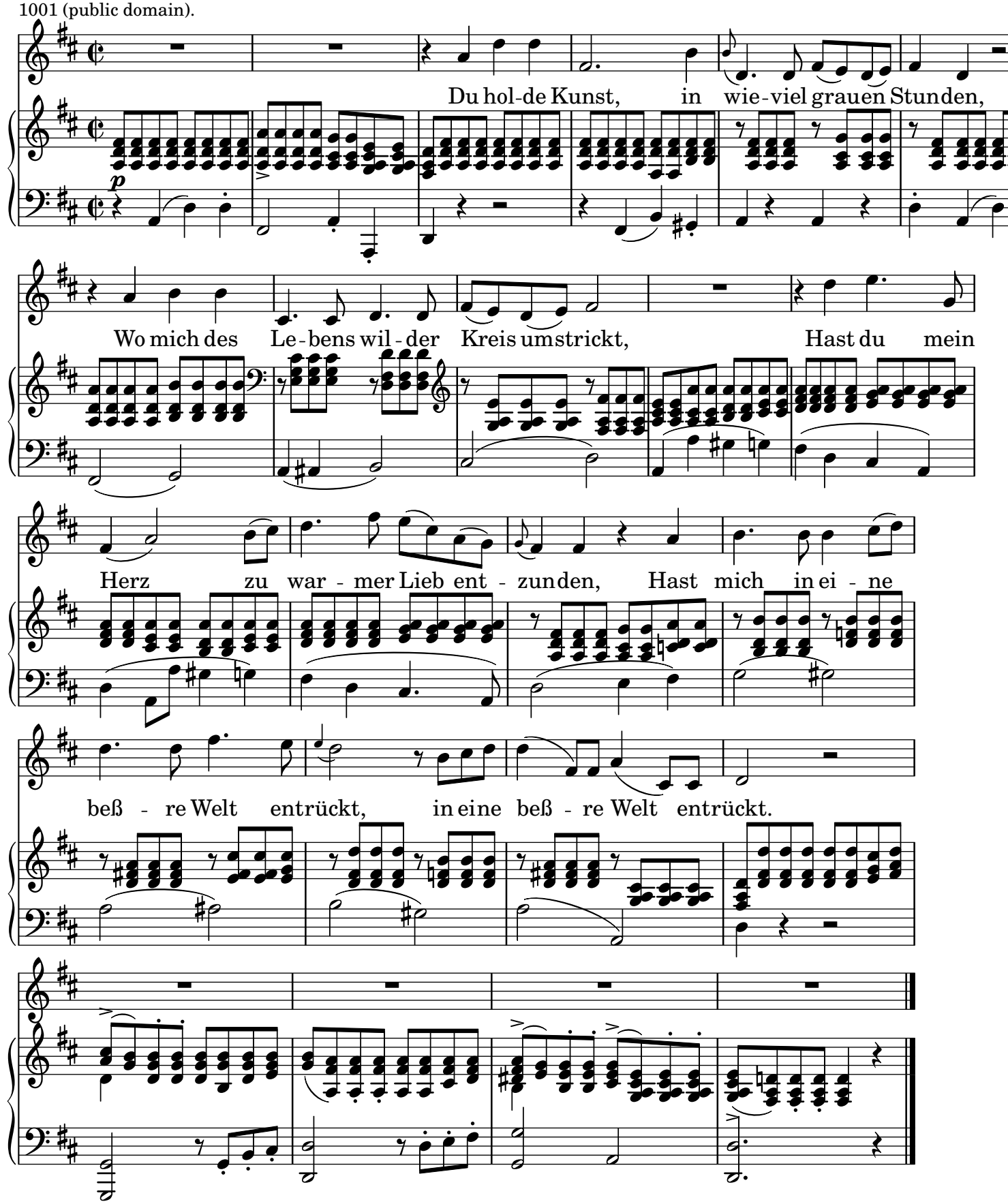
A singer's line over a light after-beat accompaniment (rests on the beat, chords after it). The singer's paired sixteenths (beamed together) carry one syllable each. Bars 10 and 12 have pauses: the piano waits for the singer. The last two bars are the piano's postlude, with two grace notes. Words: "A boy saw a little rose on the heath ..." Source: Mutopia Project no. 1555 (public domain).



An die Musik ♩ = 36

Franz Schubert (1817), An die Musik D. 547 (words by Franz von Schober) - the first verse
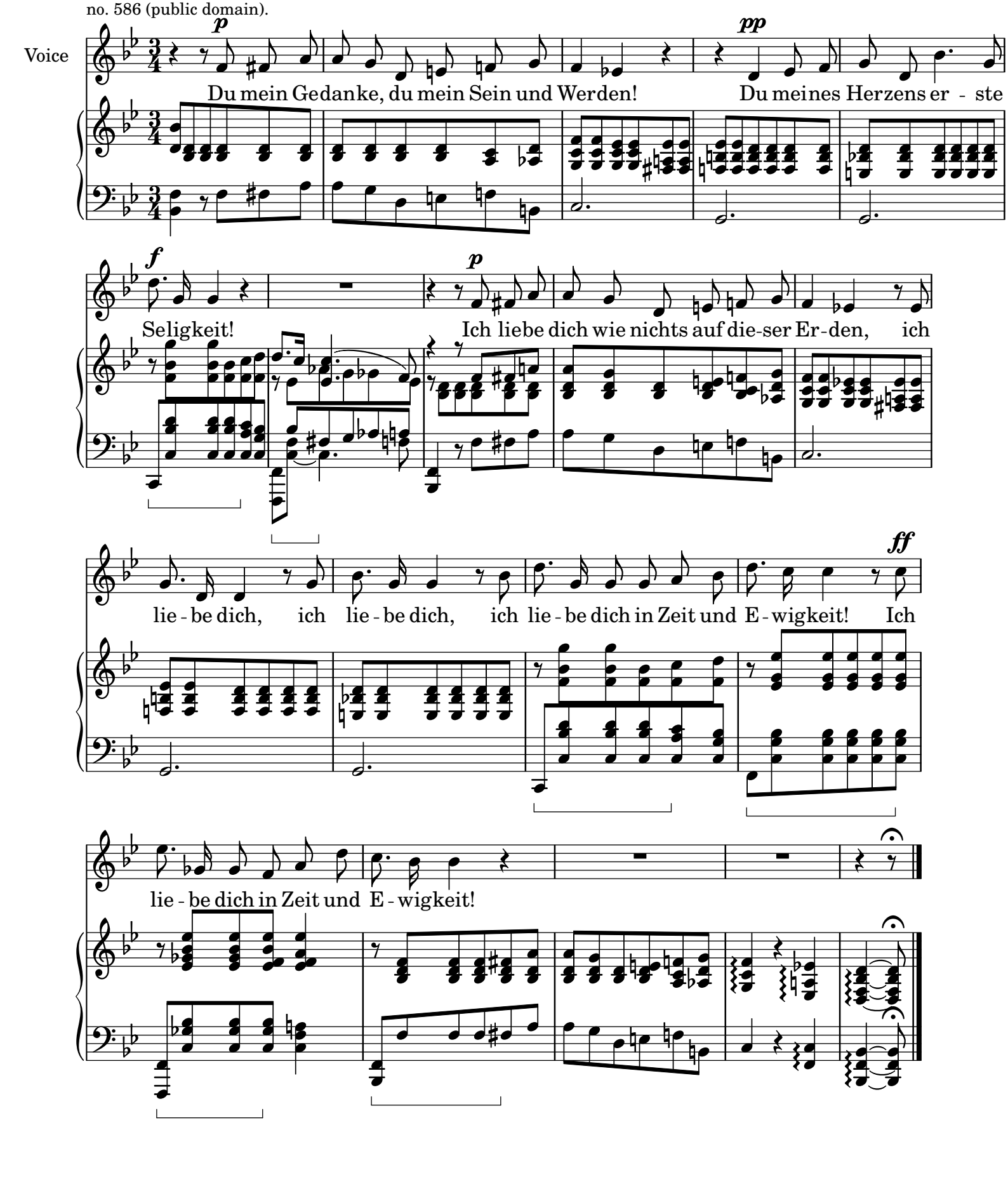
"To music": a hymn of thanks. The piano's right hand repeats its chords in eighths while the left hand's bass line sings against the voice (in bars 7-18 it moves in long notes, often by half steps). Two bars of introduction; the voice rests in bar 10 (count it) and the piano closes the verse alone. Words: "You lovely art, in how many grey hours ... you have carried me into a better world." Source: Mutopia Project no. 1001 (public domain).



Ich liebe dich ♩= 60

Edvard Grieg (1864), Ich liebe dich Op. 5 No. 3 (German words by F. von Holstein) - the verse, from bar 3
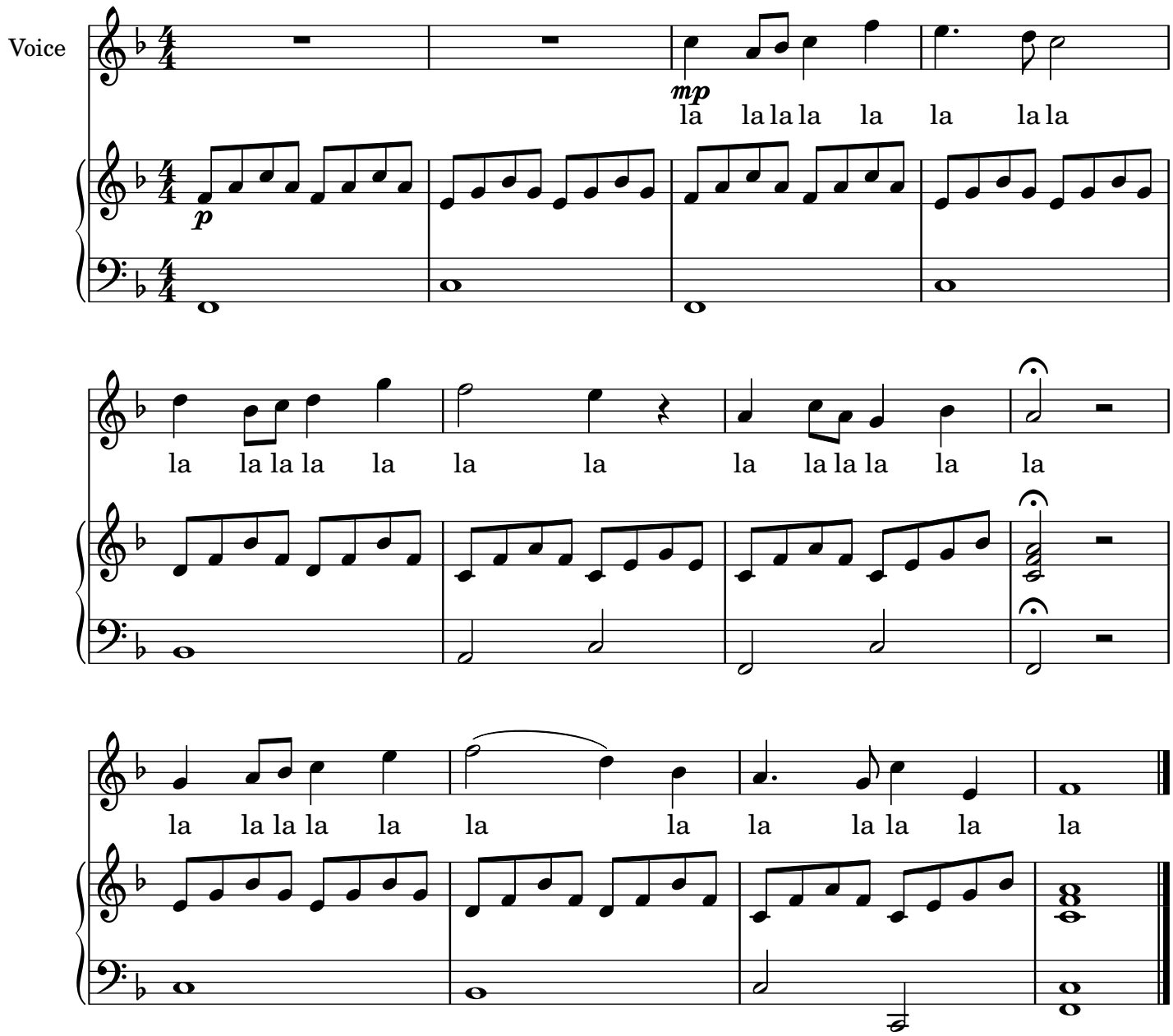
"I love you": a romantic song in which the piano breathes with the singer. The right hand's chords move in eighths, the left hand sings its own line (bars 2 and 9) and holds long basses with the pedal. From bar 11 the music grows (cresc. sempre) to the top of the phrase in bar 15; then a short ritardando. The excerpt starts with the singer's first upbeat and ends with the song's last bar. Source: Mutopia Project no. 586 (public domain).



Evening Song ♩= 66

Original, written for this book

A song for a singer and a pianist, to be played with a friend if you can (or sing the top line while you play). Two bars of introduction in broken chords; the singer comes in on bar 3. In bar 8 the singer holds a pause (fermata): the pianist holds the chord, watches, and starts bar 9 with the singer's next breath.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 7?

- Play two new exercises from each part at the speed shown, with no more than one stop each, reading the singer's line as you go.
- Pass if every introduction and interlude is in time, and you can say at any moment which word or note the singer has reached.
- Pass if you can play Heidenroslein and the Evening Song at sight (with a singer if possible), and An die Musik after a few days.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 7.